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EXPERIMENT 01

Low code versus traditional development

Aim

Compare building the Vehicle Service Command Center in Zoho Creator with a traditional web stack, for the same service-center requirements.

Procedure

1. Define one common scope: service request entry, status tracking (Requested, In Diagnosis, In Repair, Ready for Pickup, Delivered), bay occupancy, owner search, ready-for-pickup notification, and role-based access.
2. Sketch two architectures. Low code: Creator forms, reports, Page Builder, Deluge, connections. Traditional: web UI, REST API, relational database, authentication service, CI/CD and monitoring.
3. Trace one transaction (moving a vehicle to Ready for Pickup) through both. Note where status validation, authorization and notification are enforced.
4. Break work into data model, interface, business rules, testing, integration, deployment. Record measured time if you build both; otherwise label every figure 'estimate'.
5. Score each approach 1 to 5 against criteria with weights fixed before scoring. Do not claim the result is universal.

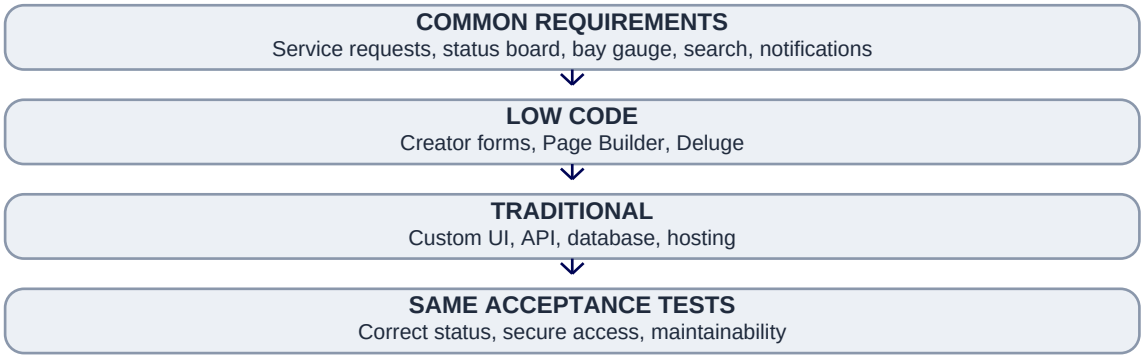
Implementation and verification

Criterion	Creator approach	Traditional approach
Initial delivery	Forms, reports and pages are built visually; fastest for a drag-and-drop Kanban board.	UI, API, database and board component must be assembled.
Customization	Deluge, widgets and APIs within platform limits.	Full control of libraries and runtime.
Operations	Managed hosting; plan limits matter.	Team runs hosting, backups, upgrades.
Portability	Export data; proprietary logic must be rewritten.	Depends on chosen services.
Cost	Per-user licensing, plan capacity.	Development, hosting, support.

Evidence and testing

E01: architecture sketches, requirements checklist, weighted scoring sheet, labelled estimates or recorded timings.

Process diagram



Generated explanatory diagram. It is not a screenshot of an executed workflow.

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Result

Expected result and verification criteria. The comparison shows where Creator suits a routine service-center workflow and where custom code may be justified. All cost and time values are labelled as measured or estimated.